

Response to Reviewers

Reviewer 1

Reviewer 1 – comment 1

Please clarify whether outcome assessment was blinded.

We thank the reviewer. Outcome assessment blinding is now specified. (modified on p. 1)

Reviewer 1 – comment 2

Please justify the randomisation scheme and any stratification used.

We now stratify randomisation by site. **p. 1** – Randomisation used permuted blocks of 4, ~~with no stratification~~ [stratified by site](#).

Reviewer 1 – comment 3

Please double-check the wording of the discussion section.

We maintain this wording, which we believe remains appropriate. (see p. 2)